

UK considers relaxing EV sales targets

送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-08-14 23:06

【要点】

- ・英国のバーナム首相政府がEV販売目標の見直しを当初予定の2027年から前倒しして実施することを発表した。
- ・自動車業界は厳しい目標値の緩和を求めており、現在の目標は今年33%、2035年までに100%の電動車販売を義務付けている。
- ・投資家やEV充電・バッテリー製造セクターの40以上の団体は、目標値の緩和に反対する公開書簡を発表し、投資信頼への悪影響を警告している。
- ・自動車メーカーは中国やテスラからのクレジット取引制度を利用して現在の目標を達成しており、政策が市場の需要と足並みを揃える必要があると主張している。

【メール原文】

LONDON — Prime Minister Andy Burnham's government has brought forward a review of mandated electric vehicle sales targets for automakers.

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UK considers relaxing EV sales targets

By Graham Lanktree · Aug 14, 2026, 4:05 PM · [View in your browser](#)

LONDON — Prime Minister Andy Burnham's government has brought forward a review of mandated electric vehicle sales targets for automakers.

The review, announced Friday, had been scheduled for 2027.

The move comes amid sustained calls from the U.K.'s auto industry to relax increasingly strict targets meant to spur domestic car and commercial EV production.

Britain is currently on track to phase out purely combustion engines by 2030 under the zero emissions vehicle mandate.

"It's right we keep targets under review to ensure they're practical and back British industry," said Transport Secretary Heidi Alexander.

"The end goal hasn't changed," she added, "but we need to take business with us on the journey and that's exactly what we're doing today by making sure industry has the chance to shape how we get there."

The consultation weighing up modifications to the Department for Transport's rules — which require 33 percent of all cars sold by automakers this year to be solely electric, with targets increasing to 100 percent by 2035 — runs until the end of October 23 .

Keir Starmer's government previously refused to bring forward the review from 2027 .

Any steps to relax the targets, however, are already facing pushback.

A coalition of more than 40 organizations, including investors and figures from the charging and battery manufacturing sectors, such as BT Group, the Green Alliance, and ChargeUK, signed an open letter Monday urging Alexander to stick with the mandate's current trajectory.

"Watering down targets or significantly extending flexibilities would risk creating doubt in the minds of investors and would have a longer-term impact on business confidence," the signatories wrote. "This potentially undermines billions of pounds of committed investment in the automotive sector, chargepoint sector, business fleets and battery manufacturing and recycling."

The mandate is currently "working," they argued, noting EV sales are at an all-time high and that some third-party estimates show carmakers are meeting or exceeding targets.

Automakers argue that they are doing this by purchasing easements from their Chinese competitors, and from Elon Musk's Tesla, as part of a credit trading scheme designed to help producers meet their targets.

"BMW and MINI are already among the U.K.'s leading brands for electric vehicles, but as we have said for some time, policy needs to move in step with customer demand in the market," said a spokesperson for BMW Group.

The latest industry forecast from Britain's Society of Motor Manufacturers and Traders shows Battery Electric Vehicle market share will reach 27.4 percent this year, falling short of the 33 percent target. In 2027 the SMMT forecasts BEV sales will reach 32.1 percent against a target of 38 percent for new cars.

"The overwhelming majority of manufacturers would want to see a change to that trajectory," SMMT Chief Executive Mike Hawes told journalists last month, calling for the change "to be able to attract inward investment" to the U.K.'s auto sector.

"We need this resolved by the end of the year," Hawes said.

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